

BlackBerry 2.0 Beta gets Facebook

Research In Motion (RIM) released Facebook for BlackBerry smartphones 2.0 Beta

HTTPS is more Seure

In HTTPS the "S" in the URL stands for Secure, making much harder for anyone to track what you are doing

Canon SX30IS

High quality ultra zoom

The SX30IS is Canon's latest ultra zoom, taking over from the SX20IS, and offering a massive 35x optical zoom. The SX30IS feels well built, with quality plastics, and has a nice grip, which, while not substantial is adequate. The mode dial on the top has a nice positive feel, while the buttons on the rear are well spaced out. The rear dial cycles through onscreen options and has smooth operation. The articulated LCD is quite clear, and the optical viewfinder is really a carbon copy of what you see on your LCD, and not really an optical unit, but as far as non-dSLRs go, it is pretty much the norm. When zooming, the lens feels better built than the SX20IS.

As is the norm with such tiny, densely packed sensors, the SX30IS was expected to produce noise in anything more than base ISOs, and in this regard it doesn't disappoint. Even at ISO 400, noise is visible, and this is not film-like grain, but digital artifacts, with off-coloured pixels. This is acceptable for small sized photos, which is mostly what people who buy such a camera will click.

Outdoors, at base ISO 100, there is much less noise, and this is more like film grain. The SX30IS produces decent detail, and good highlighting, but clipping is noticeable in many shots. Colours are neutral, but the dynamic range is slightly limited. The 35x zoom is a winner. Even at



the long end, image stabilisation works pretty well. Video capture at 720p offers good quality, though there will be some visible noise, especially when shooting indoors or under dim lighting.

For ₹25,000, the SX30IS is a good offering for those needing a long zoom and offers very acceptable quality for most shutterbugs. However, if you are a discerning sort in terms of image quality, there is some noise at lower ISOs too – the demerits of having a tiny 14-megapixel sensor.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Sensor 14-megapixel; zoom: 24-840mm (35x); battery: 1050 mAh; weight: 601 grams (including battery)

Contact

Canon India Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 1800-345-33-66

Email: info@canon.co.in

Web site: www.canon.co.in

Price: ₹28,995

6.5/10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	6.0
Value for money.....	6.0

Specifications

Frequency response: 14-44000 Hz; impedance: 300 ohms; max sound pressure level: 102 dB; weight (without cable): 330 grams

Contact

Sennheiser Electronics

India

Phone: +91 (0124) 4187800

Email: info@sennheiserindia.com

Web site: www.sennheiserindia.com

Price: ₹74,995

7.25/10

Features.....	8.0
Performance.....	8.5
Build.....	7.5
Value for money.....	5.0

Sennheiser HD 800

For the serious headphone-audiophile only

The HD 800 has a brand new design – compared to the HD 650 – new earcups, a much improved OFC cable, new ring radiator drivers especially designed to do away with the congested soundstage that headphones are known for. They look space age too – and very well built, with a lot of metal in the design. They're a comfortable, secure fit, and while the padding on the earcup looks thin, it's adequate.

These headphones need serious amping. We used a Woo Audio 6SE to power it. If you listen to the HD 800 straight out of your soundcard, you'll wonder

what the fuss is about. When amped, the mid-range clears up, and there is more space between each performer. While not as good as speakers at imaging, the soundstage is expansive – in fact, this would be one of the standout features. Bass is tight, impactful and pleasant, not boomy. The mid-range is wide and open, clear, and rather neutral. The highs are equally well represented – no hint of sibilance, but the HD 800 extends all the way to the top. If anything, the HD 800 has a bit more energy in the upper frequency range, but for all practical purposes, the HD 800 is far more neutral than the HD 650 was.

The price tag of ₹74,995 will make most people faint, but these aren't regular cans. However, considering that you'll need to double this amount for a good amplifier and a DAC... they're overpriced – as any headphone over ₹40,000 is; but if you seek sonic bliss, this will get you close.

Michael Browne

